UNIT 13

Social Justice



Learning Objectives

This Social Justice chapter – Provides insights into

- Several dimensions of the concept of Social Justice
- Significance of Social Justice
- The meaning and importance of distributive justice. -Impact of Social hierarchy
- John Rawls perspective of fair and just society
- Social Justice Movements in Tamil Nadu.
- The concept/political principle of Affirmative Action/Positive Discrimination.
- Caste discrimination and its consequences
- Egalitarian society
- Reservation policy and its essentiality
- Government's role in upliftment
- Privileges and its impact

13. 1 What do you mean by Social Justice?

The negative values which are made by the society results in inequality and cleavation among people. Social power is the dominant phenomenon which leads to cut-throat competition and ends in absolute control of the subjects. It is in order to protect the social identity, the dominant communities endeavor to capture the power sector. Among different communities in a plural society, dominance of a single group is considered as unfair and unjust. The dominant groups activate racial, religious, caste, lingual and cultural feelings and intend to misuse the social rights of other groups that may end in permanent hostility between different groups. The struggle that is undertaken by the weaker groups in order to react for establishing equal society is known to be Social Justice.

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Background of Social Hierarchy



The ancient Indian civilization had evolved with the "Varnashrama Dharma" which kick-started the principle of hierarchy i.e. Upper and Lower strata. The Varna system is also called as "Four Varna System" by which people were divided as *Brahmins, Kshatriyas, Vysyas and Shudras.*

Those sections who have been beyond these Varna classification were categories as scheduled castes and scheduled tribes. During the colonial period these depressed communities were classified as panchamas who were victims of untouchability. This division on the basis of birth has been inculcated and socialized along different phases of civilization from which inequalities surfaced in the society.

Article 15 (4) of Indian Constitution

Article 29 (2) may not act as an obstacle in making special policy decisions for socially and educationally backward communities or SC/ST people.

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